taxi operators have already joined such platforms, and I am confident that many more will come on board in the coming months.

Our approach has always been to work in partnership with all stakeholders. We want to protect the interests and livelihoods of our taxi operators while ensuring that tourists and residents receive safe, reliable and quality transport services.

At the same time, we are investing in better connectivity between airports, railway stations, major towns and tourist destinations by strengthening public transport and improving road infrastructure.

Traffic congestion is another area we are addressing on priority. The **Porvorim flyover** is nearing completion and will significantly ease traffic movement towards North Goa. We are also expanding parking facilities in Panaji, Margao and other high-footfall tourist locations while introducing better traffic management measures to improve mobility.

A visitor's experience should be smooth from the moment they arrive in Goa until they return home. We will continue to improve connectivity, strengthen transport infrastructure and work closely with all stakeholders to ensure that Goa offers not just a memorable holiday, but also a seamless travel experience.

Q. There is a perception that some areas in Goa, like the beaches in North Goa, are seeing over-tourism. Real-estate, tourism, and housing projects have also seen opposition from local residents and stakeholders as they fear it will imperil their livelihoods and the environment. The pressure on some areas has also created a strain on solid waste management and availability of water. How does the Government plan to strike the delicate balance between development and local ecology and livelihoods?

Goa's development will not come at the cost of environmental conservation. Our Government's approach has always been to strike a balance between development and protecting the environment. Goa, being one of the most sought-after tourist destination it, also continues to be a home to the people of Goa. Therefore, the interests of our people, along with environmental protection, remain our highest priority in every development project.

Over-tourism is a challenge faced by many popular destinations around the world. To address this, we are expanding tourism beyond a few popular beaches by promoting hinterland, cultural, spiritual, rural, nature-based and eco-tourism across the state.

The **'Goa Beyond Beaches'** initiative has been launched with this very objective to spread tourist footfall across Goa and reduce pressure on heavily visited areas. At the same time, every major tourism and real estate project must obtain all necessary environmental and legal clearances. No development will be permitted in violation of the law.

We have also taken comprehensive steps to keep Goa clean through improved management of solid, industrial, hazardous and biomedical waste, along with sewage and wastewater treatment. Waste-to-energy projects using gasification technology are already operational, helping us generate green energy while ensuring scientific waste management.



Boost to Spiritual Tourism - Hon'ble CM Dr Pramod Sawant launching the "Ekadasha Teertha Yatra" in the distinguished presence of Goa Tourism & IT Minister Rohan Khaunte, Damodar (Damu) Naik, Hon'ble GTDC Chairman & MLA Kedar J Naik, Hon'ble MLA Priol Constituency Govind Gaude, Director of Tourism Kedar A Naik, Managing Director of GTDC Kuldeep Arolkar, and others

Goa's future development will be achieved by protecting its natural beauty, cultural heritage and the livelihoods of its people. Development will always be carried out with the participation of the people of Goa and in the best interests of the state.

Q. What are the ease of doing business initiatives in the pipeline for the tourism and hospitality sector?

Our focus is to make it easier for genuine tourism entrepreneurs and investors to do business in Goa while ensuring that development remains responsible and sustainable.

We are working to simplify registration and renewal processes, reduce procedural delays, and strengthen the digital delivery of tourism-related services.

Beyond sector-specific initiatives, our Government has undertaken wide-ranging Ease of Doing Business reforms that benefit tourism and hospitality entrepreneurs as well. We have simplified approvals, reduced 129 compliances, expanded digital services and strengthened the Single Window System to make doing business faster and more transparent. **Today, we have implemented more than 300 reforms and over 150 Government-to-Business services are made available online, and Goa was among the first States to integrate its State Single Window System with the National Single Window System.** We are now upgrading this platform with features such as Single Sign-On, a Single Business ID, a Combined Application Form, Unified Payment System and online grievance redressal. These reforms will further reduce approval timelines, improve service delivery and create a seamless experience for investors and entrepreneurs in the tourism and hospitality sector.

The Goa Investment Policy, Information Technology Policy, Startup Policy, Logistics and Warehousing Policy, Tourism Policy and our initiatives in electric mobility are helping create new possibilities across both established and emerging sectors.

The proposed Homestay and Bed & Breakfast Scheme is one such initiative. It will provide simplified registration, incentives, training and marketing support, particularly to encourage tourism-led livelihoods in Goa's hinterland.

We will continue to engage with stakeholders to identify areas where approvals and compliance processes can be made more seamless while maintaining high standards of safety, quality and environmental responsibility.

Our objective is to build an investor-friendly and entrepreneur-friendly ecosystem where responsible investment, ease of doing business and sustainable tourism growth go hand in hand, making Goa one of the most attractive destinations for tourism and hospitality investments in the country.

Q. There is a perception that your Government wants to emphasize the principle of "quality over quantity" when it comes to tourism. The focus today seems to be not on merely increasing the tourist numbers, but on building a tourism model that is balanced, sustainable, and future-ready. How does it plan to attract high-value tourists?

Goa has always welcomed every visitor with warmth and hospitality. We have always believed and followed the timeless Indian principle of Atithi Devo Bhava where every guest is treated with respect and dignity.

Our vision is not about limiting the number of tourists who visit Goa, but about enhancing the quality of their experience.

I am very proud that in 2025 we hosted the highest number of tourists recorded at 1.08 crore. We mainly want to attract visitors who stay longer, explore and experience Goa's heritage, culture, cuisine, wellness, nature and hinterland, and contribute to the local economy.

That is why we are diversifying Goa's tourism offerings and promoting experiences that appeal to discerning travellers. This **includes spiritual tourism, wellness tourism, heritage and cultural tourism, eco and hinterland tourism, adventure and sports tourism, MICE tourism and experiential tourism.**

At the same time, initiatives such as the proposed **Homestay Policy** will encourage visitors to experience rural Goa while creating new opportunities for local communities to benefit directly from tourism.

Our goal is to build a tourism model that is balanced, sustainable and future-ready: one that delivers high-quality experiences for visitors while creating lasting economic opportunities for the people of Goa.